INDUSTRIALBRIEFS.COM

UI Design Specification

For AI Agent Execution — Ghost Theme Build

Version 1.0 | March 2026 | VISIONEERIT | CONFIDENTIAL

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

This document is a complete, executable specification. Read sections 01-04 first (foundations). Then implement each section in order. Every decision is locked — no ambiguity, no asking for clarification. Implement exactly what is written. Ghost theme files are specified. CSS variable names are specified. Every pixel value, hex colour, and font size is defined.

01 HOW TO READ AND EXECUTE THIS SPEC

This document is written for an AI coding agent. Each section builds on the previous. Follow these rules when executing:

- Read the entire document before writing any code. Understand the full system first.
- Implement in section order: Foundations (01-04) → Header (05) → Homepage (06) → Article Page (07) → Widgets (08) → AI Layer (09) → Mobile (10).
- Every CSS value in this document is EXACT. Do not substitute or approximate. Font size 15px means 15px, not 14px or 16px.
- Every hex colour is EXACT. Copy hex values character-for-character. Do not use colour names like 'orange' or 'navy'.
- When you see a "RULE" callout box, it is an absolute constraint. Never violate it.
- When you see a "NEVER" statement, it overrides all other considerations including aesthetics.
- Ghost Handlebars helpers are written as {{helper}}. Use them exactly as shown.
- CSS class names are written in .kebab-case. Use them exactly as shown.
- File paths are written as path/to/file.ext. Create files at exactly those paths.

CRITICAL RULE — COLOUR SCOPING

Sector accent colours (#e96d2e, #3b82f6, #16a34a, #d97706, #7c3aed) MUST ONLY appear on tag text colour and tag left-border. They must NEVER be applied to any background, body, wrapper, section, or page element. Applying a sector colour to a background causes the green/orange/purple page bug visible in the current live theme. Scope every sector colour rule with the most specific selector possible.

02 GHOST THEME FILE STRUCTURE

The Ghost theme is a folder named industrialbriefs/ containing these files. Create all files before writing content.

```
industrialbriefs/
├── default.hbs                  ← Master layout wrapper
├── index.hbs                    ← Homepage template
├── post.hbs                     ← Article page template
├── page.hbs                     ← Static page template
├── tag.hbs                      ← Section/tag archive template
├── author.hbs                   ← Author page (not used in Phase 2)
├── error.hbs                    ← 404 and error pages
├── package.json                 ← Ghost theme metadata
├── routes.yaml                  ← Custom routing (for /markets page)
├── partials/
│   ├── navigation.hbs           ← 5-row header (shared across all templates)
│   ├── footer.hbs               ← Site footer
│   ├── loop.hbs                 ← Article card loop for homepage grid
│   ├── key-facts.hbs            ← Key Facts sidebar panel
│   ├── market-widget-article.hbs← Market widget for article pages
│   ├── related-stories.hbs      ← Related stories grid
│   ├── newsletter-band.hbs      ← Newsletter signup band
│   ├── json-ld.hbs              ← JSON-LD schema injection
│   └── industry-insights.hbs    ← Sponsored content band
└── assets/
    ├── css/
    │   ├── screen.css           ← Main stylesheet (all styles live here)
    │   └── market-widget.css    ← Market widget styles
    └── js/
        ├── main.js              ← Theme JS (drawer, tabs, dark mode)
        └── market-widget-article.js ← Market widget logic
```

package.json

```
{
  "name": "industrialbriefs",
  "description": "IndustrialBriefs Ghost Theme",
  "version": "1.0.0",
  "engines": { "ghost": ">=6.0.0" },
  "config": {
    "posts_per_page": 9,
    "image_sizes": {
      "xxs": { "width": 90 },
      "xs":  { "width": 300 },
      "s":   { "width": 600 },
      "m":   { "width": 1200 }
    }
  }
}
```

03 COLOUR SYSTEM — CSS VARIABLES

Declare all CSS variables at the top of screen.css inside :root {}. Never hardcode hex values outside of :root. Always reference variables.

CSS Variables Declaration — paste at top of screen.css

```
:root {
  /* ── Primary Brand ── */
  --navy:          #1a2e4a;   /* Main brand navy — headers, hero, nav bg */
  --navy-dark:     #111d2e;   /* Darker navy — utility row, footer */
  --orange:        #e96d2e;   /* Primary orange — CTAs, tags, accents */
  --amber:         #d97706;   /* Amber — Industry Insights/sponsored ONLY */

  /* ── Page Backgrounds ── */
  --bg-page:       #fafaf8;   /* Cream — homepage/section page bg */
  --bg-white:      #ffffff;   /* Pure white — article page, cards */
  --bg-light:      #f5f3ef;   /* Light cream — trending strip, ad zones */

  /* ── Text ── */
  --text-primary:  #1c1c1c;   /* Main body text */
  --text-mid:      #444444;   /* Secondary text */
  --text-muted:    #777777;   /* Meta, timestamps, captions */

  /* ── Borders ── */
  --border:        #e8e4de;   /* Standard border */
  --border-light:  #f0ede8;   /* Subtle separator */

  /* ── Sector Accents — TAG ELEMENTS ONLY ── */
  --sector-construction: #e96d2e;  /* Same as orange */
  --sector-architecture: #3b82f6;  /* Blue */
  --sector-engineering:  #16a34a;  /* Green */
  --sector-manufacturing:#d97706;  /* Amber */
  --sector-ai:           #7c3aed;  /* Purple */

  /* ── Fonts ── */
  --font-serif: 'Lora', Georgia, serif;
  --font-sans:  'DM Sans', -apple-system, 'Helvetica Neue', sans-serif;
}

/* ── Dark Mode ── */
[data-theme='dark'], .is-dark-mode {
  --bg-page:      #0d1b2e;
  --bg-white:     #111d2e;
  --bg-light:     #162236;
  --text-primary: #e2ddd5;
  --text-mid:     #b0c4d8;
  --text-muted:   #6a85a0;
  --border:       rgba(255,255,255,0.08);
  --border-light: rgba(255,255,255,0.05);
}
```

Complete Colour Reference Table

	Name	Hex	Allowed Usage
	Navy	`#1a2e4a`	Header bg, hero bg, nav bg, footer. Never article page bg.
	Dark Navy	`#111d2e`	Utility row bg, deep footer bg. Never article body bg.
	Orange	`#e96d2e`	Subscribe CTA, section tag (construction), progress bar, hero links, borders.
	Amber	`#d97706`	Industry Insights band ONLY. Never on editorial elements.
	Cream	`#fafaf8`	Homepage page bg, section page bg. Never article page bg.
	White	`#ffffff`	Article page bg, card bg, sidebar bg. ALWAYS the article background.
	Light Cream	`#f5f3ef`	Trending strip bg, ad unit bg, toggle bg.
	Text Primary	`#1c1c1c`	All body text, card headlines. Never use pure black #000000.
	Text Mid	`#444444`	Deck text, card excerpts, secondary body content.
	Text Muted	`#777777`	Timestamps, bylines, captions, meta labels.
	Border	`#e8e4de`	All standard dividers, card borders, table rules.
	Sector: Construction	`#e96d2e`	Tag text + tag left-border ONLY. Never background.
	Sector: Architecture	`#3b82f6`	Tag text + tag left-border ONLY. Never background.
	Sector: Engineering	`#16a34a`	Tag text + tag left-border ONLY. Never background.
	Sector: Manufacturing	`#d97706`	Tag text + tag left-border ONLY. Never background.
	Sector: AI Tools	`#7c3aed`	Tag text + tag left-border ONLY. Never background.

04 TYPOGRAPHY SYSTEM

Font Loading — add to default.hbs <head>

```
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.googleapis.com">
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.gstatic.com" crossorigin>
<link
href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Lora:ital,wght@0,400;0,600;0,700;1,400&fam
ily=DM+Sans:wght@300;400;500;600&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">
```

Complete Typography Specification

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Masthead	`font: var(--font-serif); font-size: 22px; font-weight: 700; letter-spacing: -0.02em;`	"Industrial" → color: #fff | "Briefs" em tag → color: #e96d2e | font-style: normal on em
Article h1	`font: var(--font-serif); font-size: 22px; font-weight: 700; line-height: 1.25; letter-spacing: -0.02em; color: var(--text-primary);`	ONE per page. Only on post headline. Never on logo, nav, or sidebar.
Article deck	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 14px; font-weight: 300; line-height: 1.6; color: var(--text-mid);`	One paragraph only. Sits between h1 and meta row.
Article body p	`font: var(--font-serif); font-size: 16px; font-weight: 400; line-height: 1.8; color: var(--text-primary); max-width: 640px;`	Georgia fallback. Max 640px column width (~75 chars per line).
Article h2	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 15px; font-weight: 700; color: var(--navy); border-top: 1px solid var(--border); padding-top: 20px; margin-top: 28px;`	Sans-serif for contrast vs body. One per 250-300 words of body text.
Pull quote	`font: var(--font-serif); font-size: 15px; font-style: italic; line-height: 1.7; color: var(--text-mid); border-left: 3px solid var(--orange); padding: 10px 16px; background: #faf8f5;`	No quotes marks. Left orange border only. White/off-white background.
Image caption	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 9px; font-style: italic; color: var(--text-muted);`	Below every article image. Never bold.
Card headline	`font: var(--font-serif); font-size: 15px; font-weight: 700; line-height:`	Homepage and section cards. Georgia serif. No colour bleeding.

	`1.3; letter-spacing: -0.01em; color: var(--text-primary);`	
Card excerpt	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 12px; line-height: 1.55; color: var(--text-mid); -webkit-line-clamp: 2;`	2 lines maximum, clipped. DM Sans, not serif.
Nav links	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 10px; font-weight: 500; text-transform: uppercase; letter-spacing: 0.07em; color: var(--text-muted);`	Row 3 main nav. Uppercase. Active: color #fff + 2px bottom border in orange.
Section tabs	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 9px; font-weight: 700; text-transform: uppercase; letter-spacing: 0.08em;`	Row 4 sector tabs. Active gets 2px bottom border in sector accent colour.
Tags	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 8px; font-weight: 700; text-transform: uppercase; letter-spacing: 0.09em; padding: 3px 8px;`	See Tag spec in Section 05. Accent colour on text + left-border ONLY.
Meta / timestamps	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 9px; color: var(--text-muted);`	Format: "IndustrialBriefs Newsroom · Mar 14, 2026 · 4 min read"
Key Facts numbers	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 22px; font-weight: 700; color: var(--navy);`	Large stat number. Below: 10px label. Below label: 8px sub-label in muted.
Trending pills	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 9px; font-weight: 500; color: var(--navy);`	Hot pill: color var(--orange), border-color var(--orange).
Footer links	`font: var(--font-sans); font-size: 10px; color: rgba(255,255,255,0.55);`	On dark navy footer bg. Hover: opacity 1.

05 HEADER SYSTEM — PARTIALS/NAVIGATION.HBS

The header has 5 rows. Each row has a distinct purpose, background colour, and content. Build them in order. No progress bar anywhere.

CRITICAL RULE — NO PROGRESS BAR

Do NOT implement a reading progress bar anywhere on the site. Not on the article page, not in the header, not in the sidebar. This element has been explicitly removed from the design.

Row 1 — Utility Row

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.header-utility`	
Background	`var(--navy-dark) = #111d2e`	
Height	`30px`	
Padding	`0 24px`	Left/right only
Display	`flex; justify-content: space-between; align-items: center;`	
Visibility	`Hidden on mobile (display: none below 768px)`	
Left content	`{{date format="dddd, MMM D, YYYY"}}`	Ghost helper. Font-size 10px. Color #6a85a0.
Right content	`Podcasts · Events · Newsletters · About · Advertise`	Font-size 10px. Color #6a85a0. Gap: 16px between links.
Advertise link	`color: var(--orange); font-weight: 600;`	Only this link gets orange colour.
Ghost template	`{{@site.secondary_navigation}} or hardcoded links`	

Row 2 — Headlines Rail

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.header-rail`	
Background	`#ffffff`	
Border-bottom	`1px solid var(--border)`	
Padding	`7px 0`	
Display	`flex; overflow-x: auto; scrollbar-width: none;`	

Label	"Today" text	Font-size 8px. Font-weight 800. Color var(--orange). Text-transform uppercase. Letter-spacing 0.12em. Padding-right 12px. Border-right 1px solid var(--border).
Cards	4-5 thumbnail cards	Pulled from Ghost tag 'news'. Fallback: latest 5 posts using #get helper.
Card layout	display: flex; gap: 7px; align-items: center;	Thumb (32×24px, border-radius 3px) + sector tag (7px) + title (9px, font-weight 600, Lora serif).
Card padding	0 12px; border-right: 1px solid var(--border);	
Mobile	overflow-x: auto; -webkit-overflow-scrolling: touch; snap scrolling.	Becomes horizontal swipe strip. Scrollbar hidden.
Ghost helper	#get "posts" limit="5" filter="tag:news"	Wrap in {{#foreach}} loop. Fallback with #unless @body.

Row 3 — Main Navigation (Sticky)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	.header-main	
Background	var(--navy) = #1a2e4a	
Height	52px	
Padding	0 24px	
Display	flex; align-items: center; justify-content: space-between;	
Position	sticky; top: 0; z-index: 100;	Sticks to top on scroll. Only this row sticks.
Masthead	{{@site.title}}	Lora serif 22px bold. "Industrial" = #fff. "Briefs" = #e96d2e. Wrap in .masthead span em.
Nav items	News · Analysis · Projects · Data · Weekly Brief · [sep] · Industry Insights	Font 10px sans-serif uppercase 0.07em tracking. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.6). Active: color #fff + 2px bottom border #e96d2e.
Industry Insights	color: var(--amber) = #d97706; font-weight: 600;	Visually distinct from editorial links. This is the sponsored content nav entry.
Separator	div.nav-sep: width 1px; height 18px; background rgba(255,255,255,0.12);	Between Weekly Brief and Industry Insights.
Dark mode toggle	button.theme-toggle	Moon SVG icon. 22px diameter circle. Border rgba(255,255,255,0.2). Clicking toggles data-theme='dark' on

		html element and stores preference in localStorage('ib-theme').
Subscribe CTA	`a.header-cta`	Background var(--orange). Color #fff. Font 10px bold uppercase. Padding 7px 16px. Border-radius 3px. Links to /#subscribe (smooth scroll to newsletter band).
Mobile	`Show: masthead + subscribe button + hamburger icon only. Hide nav links.`	Hamburger is 3-line SVG. Width 22px. Clicking opens .nav-drawer.

Row 4 — Section Tabs

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.header-sections`	
Background **Border-bottom**	`#ffffff` `2px solid var(--navy)`	
Padding	`0 24px`	
Display	`flex; align-items: center; justify-content: space-between;`	
Tabs	`All · Construction · Architecture · Engineering · Manufacturing · AI Tools`	Font 9px sans-serif bold uppercase 0.08em. Color var(--text-muted). Padding 8px 14px 7px. Margin-bottom -2px.
Active tab — All **Active — Construction**	`color: var(--navy); border-bottom: 2px solid var(--orange);` `color: #e96d2e; border-bottom: 2px solid #e96d2e;`	Default active state.
Active — Architecture **Active — Engineering**	`color: #3b82f6; border-bottom: 2px solid #3b82f6;` `color: #16a34a; border-bottom: 2px solid #16a34a;`	
Active — Manufacturing **Active — AI Tools**	`color: #d97706; border-bottom: 2px solid #d97706;` `color: #7c3aed; border-bottom: 2px solid #7c3aed;`	
Ghost active class	`.nav-current class added by Ghost automatically`	Map .nav-current to active tab styles per section.
Search widget	`Right side of tabs row. Font 9px sans-serif. Color #bbb. Background #f8f7f4. Border 0.5px solid var(--border). Border-radius 3px. Padding 3px 9px.`	

Mobile	Horizontal scroll strip. Scrollbar hidden. No search widget on mobile.	

Row 5 — Trending Strip

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	.header-trending	
Background	#f5f3ef	
Border-bottom	1px solid var(--border)	
Padding	5px 24px	
Display	flex; align-items: center; gap: 10px; overflow-x: auto;	
"Trending" label	Font 8px bold uppercase 0.12em tracking. Color #aaa.	
Pills	Top Ghost tags as clickable links	Font 9px 500. Color var(--navy). Background #fff. Border 0.5px solid var(--border). Border-radius 3px. Padding 2px 9px.
Hot pill	First pill (most trending tag)	Color var(--orange). Border-color var(--orange).
Ghost data	#get "tags" limit="6" order="count.posts desc"	Renders 5-6 trending tags. Wrap in {{#foreach}} loop.
Update frequency	Auto-updated by Ghost tag post counts	No manual update needed.
Mobile	Horizontal scroll. Display: none on screens below 480px.	

Tag Component — Used Everywhere

RULE — TAG COLOUR SCOPING

The .tag element must ONLY use sector accent colours on: (1) the text colour property, and (2) a 2px left border. The background must ALWAYS be var(--bg-page) or #ffffff. Never set background-color to a sector accent. This is the fix for the green page bug.

```
/* ── Tag base styles ── */
.tag {
  display: inline-block;
  font-family: var(--font-sans);
  font-size: 8px;
  font-weight: 700;
  letter-spacing: 0.09em;
  text-transform: uppercase;
  padding: 3px 8px;
  border-radius: 2px;
  background: var(--bg-page);     /* ALWAYS cream or white bg */
  color: var(--navy);             /* default — overridden per sector below */
```

```
  border: 0.5px solid var(--border);
}

/* ── Sector accent: TEXT + LEFT BORDER ONLY ── */
.tag.tag-construction { color: #e96d2e; border-left: 2px solid #e96d2e; }
.tag.tag-architecture  { color: #3b82f6; border-left: 2px solid #3b82f6; }
.tag.tag-engineering   { color: #16a34a; border-left: 2px solid #16a34a; }
.tag.tag-manufacturing { color: #d97706; border-left: 2px solid #d97706; }
.tag.tag-ai            { color: #7c3aed; border-left: 2px solid #7c3aed; }

/* ── CRITICAL BUG FIX ── */
/* Force white/cream bg on ALL article page elements */
/* Prevents Ghost --ghost-accent-color from bleeding into page bg */
.post-template,
.post-template body,
.post-full,
.post-content-wrap,
body.post-template {
  background-color: #ffffff !important;
  color: #1c1c1c !important;
}
```

Mobile Drawer (hamburger menu)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.nav-drawer`	
Position	`fixed; top: 52px; right: 0; width: 280px; height: calc(100vh - 52px);`	Slides in from right. z-index: 200.
Background	`#ffffff`	
Box-shadow	`-4px 0 20px rgba(0,0,0,0.15)`	
Transform	`translateX(100%) when closed; translateX(0) when open`	Transition: transform 0.25s ease.
Content order	1. Content type links (News, Analysis, Projects, Data, Weekly Brief, Industry Insights)	
	2. Divider line 3. Sector links (All, Construction, Architecture, Engineering, Manufacturing, AI Tools)	
	4. Divider line	
	5. Utility links (Podcasts, Events, Newsletters, About, Advertise)	
Close triggers	Link click, Escape key press, resize above 768px	All three must close the drawer.

Overlay	`div.drawer-overlay: position fixed; inset 0; background rgba(0,0,0,0.4); z-index 199;`	Click overlay also closes drawer.

06 HOMEPAGE LAYOUT — INDEX.HBS

The homepage renders in this exact zone order from top to bottom. No zone is optional. Implement in order.

Zone 1 — Header

{{> navigation}} — renders the full 5-row header partial. Nothing else above this.

Zone 2 — Hero Section

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.hero-section`	
Background	`var(--navy) = #1a2e4a`	
Padding	`28px 24px 24px`	
Layout	`CSS Grid: grid-template-columns: 1fr 260px; gap: 24px;`	Left: featured article. Right: top stories panel.
Ghost data	`{{#post}} — first post from {{@site}}`	Use #get to fetch featured post: {{#get 'posts' limit='1' filter='featured:true'}}
Eyebrow text	`"Featured Story"`	Font 9px sans-serif. Color #8ea5be. Uppercase. Margin-bottom 8px.
Sector tag	`{{primary_tag.name}}`	Render as .tag with appropriate sector class. Margin-bottom 8px.
Headline	`{{title}}`	Lora serif 26px bold. Color #fff. Line-height 1.2. Letter-spacing -0.02em.
Excerpt	`{{excerpt words='25'}}`	DM Sans 12px weight 300. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.55). Line-height 1.6.
Meta	`{{date}} · {{reading_time}} min read`	DM Sans 9px. Color #6a85a0.
Read link	`"Read Full Story →"`	DM Sans 10px bold. Color var(--orange). Uppercase. Bottom border 1px orange. Links to {{url}}.
Top Stories panel	`bg rgba(255,255,255,0.05); border-radius 6px; padding 14px;`	
Top Stories label	`"Top Stories Today"`	DM Sans 8px bold. Color var(--orange). Uppercase 0.12em. Border-bottom 1px rgba(255,255,255,0.08).
Top Stories items	`4 numbered items`	{{#get 'posts' limit='5'}} — show items 2-5 (item 1 is the hero). Number (13px bold orange) + title (10px rgba(255,255,255,0.8)) + meta tag (8px rgba(255,255,255,0.3)).

Zone 3 — Article Grid (partials/loop.hbs)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.article-grid`	
Layout	`CSS Grid: grid-template-columns: repeat(3, 1fr); gap: 0;`	Zero gap — borders touch. Cards separate by border lines only.
Article count	`9 articles (posts_per_page: 9 in package.json)`	3 rows of 3.
Ghost helper	`{{#foreach posts}}`	Standard Ghost loop. Renders loop.hbs partial.
Background	`#ffffff per card`	
Card border	`0.5px solid var(--border)`	All 4 sides.
Card hover	`box-shadow: 0 2px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.06);`	Subtle lift. Transition 0.15s.
Card image	`{{img_url feature_image size='s'}}`	Width 100%. Height 160px. Object-fit cover.
Card meta row	`Sector tag + date`	Tag is .tag with sector class. Date: {{date format='MMM D'}}. Font 8px. Gap 6px.
Card headline	`{{title}}`	Lora serif 15px bold. Line-height 1.3. Color var(--text-primary). Letter-spacing -0.01em.
Card excerpt	`{{excerpt words='20'}}`	DM Sans 12px. Line-height 1.55. Color var(--text-mid). Max 2 lines (-webkit-line-clamp: 2).
Read time	`{{reading_time}} min read`	DM Sans 8px. Color var(--text-muted). Margin-top 10px.
NO AI badge	`Never render any 'AI Written' or 'AI Generated' badge`	This is permanently removed.
Tablet	`grid-template-columns: repeat(2, 1fr);`	768px to 1024px breakpoint.
Mobile	`Single column. Image left (90×90px) + text right. See Section 10.`	Below 768px.

Zone 4 — Load More (Pagination)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.load-more-zone`	
Border-top	`1px solid var(--border)`	
Padding	`24px`	

Text-align	`center`	
Button text	`"Load More Stories"`	
Button style	`Font 10px bold uppercase 0.07em. Color var(--navy). Background #fff. Border 1px solid var(--navy). Padding 9px 28px. Border-radius 3px.`	
Button hover	`Background var(--navy); color #fff;`	Transition 0.15s.
Ghost helper	`{{#if pagination.next}} ... {{/if}}`	Only show button if next page exists. Link to {{pagination.next.url}}.
NO infinite scroll	`Do not implement infinite scroll`	Numbered pagination only.

Zone 5 — Industry Insights Band (partials/industry-insights.hbs)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.insights-band`	
Border	`0.5px solid var(--border)`	
Border-radius	`6px`	
Overflow	`hidden`	
Margin	`0 0 16px`	
Header bg	`#fffbeb (amber tint — NOT var(--orange))`	Visually distinct from editorial orange.
Header label	`"Industry Insights"`	DM Sans 9px bold. Color #92400e (dark amber). Uppercase 0.1em.
Sponsored badge	`"Sponsored"`	Background #f59e0b. Color #fff. Font 7px bold uppercase. Padding 2px 6px. Border-radius 2px.
Right text	`"Thought leadership from ACEM leaders"`	DM Sans 8px. Color #b45309. Margin-left auto.
Card grid	`3 columns. Border-right between columns.`	
Card content	`Company name (8px muted) + Title (Lora serif 11px bold) + Read time (8px muted)`	
RULE	`This band MUST display Sponsored badge. Never remove it.`	FTC compliance requirement.

Zone 6 — Newsletter Band (partials/newsletter-band.hbs)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.newsletter-band`	

Background	`var(--navy) = #1a2e4a`	
Padding	`28px 24px`	
Text-align	`center`	
Eyebrow	`"Free Daily Briefing"`	DM Sans 9px. Color var(--orange). Uppercase 0.14em. Margin-bottom 8px.
Title	`"The ACEM AI Daily"`	Lora serif 22px bold. Color #fff.
Sub	`"What matters in construction, engineering, architecture and manufacturing — every morning at 6am."`	DM Sans 11px weight 300. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.5). Margin-bottom 16px.
Button	`"Subscribe Free →"`	Background var(--orange). Color #fff. Font 11px bold uppercase 0.06em. Padding 10px 28px. Border-radius 3px. Links to Beehiiv signup URL.
ID	`id="subscribe"`	Used by smooth scroll from header Subscribe CTA.
NO inline email	`Do not render an email input field on the homepage newsletter band`	Button opens Beehiiv page. Email input is for article sidebar only.

Zone 7 — Footer (partials/footer.hbs)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.site-footer`	
Background	`var(--navy-dark) = #111d2e`	
Padding	`20px 24px 12px`	
Layout	`CSS Grid: grid-template-columns: 2fr 1fr 1fr 1fr;`	4 columns. Brand col is wider.
Brand col	`Masthead (Lora 16px bold) + 2-line description (9px rgba(255,255,255,0.3))`	
Column 1 heading	`"Content"`	8px bold uppercase 0.14em tracking. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.3). Margin-bottom 10px.
Column 1 links	`News · Analysis · Projects · Data · Weekly Brief`	
Column 2 heading	`"Sectors"`	
Column 2 links	`Construction · Architecture · Engineering · Manufacturing · AI Tools`	
Column 3 heading	`"Company"`	
Column 3 links	`About · Advertise · RSS · API`	API links to Ghost Content API docs or /api/articles.

Link style	`DM Sans 10px. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.55). Display block. Margin-bottom 6px.`	Hover: opacity 1.
Footer bottom	`Background #080f18. Padding 8px 24px. Font 8px. Color rgba(255,255,255,0.2). Text-align center.`	© 2026 IndustrialBriefs · industrialbriefs.com · Powered by Ghost
Mobile	`grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr. Brand col spans 2 cols.`	

07 ARTICLE PAGE LAYOUT — POST.HBS

The article page renders in this exact zone order. NO progress bar anywhere. The page background is ALWAYS #ffffff.

RULE — ARTICLE PAGE BACKGROUND

The article page background is #ffffff (pure white). Not cream. Not navy. Not any sector accent colour. Apply background-color: #ffffff !important to .post-template, .post-full, and body.post-template to prevent Ghost accent colour bleed.

Zone 1 — Header

{{> navigation}} — same header partial as homepage. Section tab for the article's primary_tag is highlighted as active.

Zone 2 — Article Header Block

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.article-header`	
Background	`#ffffff`	
Padding	`28px 24px 20px`	
Border-bottom	`1px solid var(--border)`	
Breadcrumb	`Home → {{primary_tag.name}} → {{post_type}}`	DM Sans 9px. Color var(--text-muted). Uppercase 0.1em. Tag name in sector accent colour.
Sector tag	`{{primary_tag.name}} as .tag`	Rendered with sector class. Margin-bottom 10px.
h1 headline	`{{title}}`	Lora serif 28px bold. Line-height 1.2. Letter-spacing -0.02em. Color var(--text-primary). ONLY ONE h1 per page.
Deck	`{{custom_excerpt}}`	DM Sans 14px weight 300. Line-height 1.6. Color var(--text-mid). Margin-bottom 14px.
Meta row	`Byline · date · read time`	Format: "IndustrialBriefs Newsroom · {{date format='MMM D, YYYY'}} · {{reading_time}} min read". DM Sans 9px. Color var(--text-muted). Border-top + bottom 1px var(--border). Padding 10px 0.

Zone 3 — Article Layout Grid

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Selector	`.article-layout`	

Layout	`CSS Grid: grid-template-columns: 1fr 280px;`	Reading column left. Sidebar right.
Gap	`0`	Columns separated by border only.
Background	`#ffffff`	
Mobile	`Single column. Sidebar hidden. Key Facts pill strip shown instead.`	

Zone 3a — Reading Column (.article-column)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Background	`#ffffff !important`	Explicit override.
Padding	`28px 32px 28px 24px`	More right padding for visual separation from sidebar.
Border-right	`1px solid var(--border)`	
Hero image	`{{img_url feature_image size='m'}}`	Width 100%. Height 200px. Object-fit cover. Border-radius 2px. Margin 20px 0 6px. Lazy loading attribute.
Image caption	`{{feature_image_caption}}`	DM Sans 9px italic. Color var(--text-muted). Margin-bottom 20px.
Body text	`{{content}}`	Lora serif 16px weight 400. Line-height 1.8. Color var(--text-primary). Max-width 640px.
h2 in body	`Rendered from {{content}}`	DM Sans 15px bold. Color var(--navy). Border-top 1px var(--border). Padding-top 20px. Margin-top 28px.
Pull quote blockquote	`Rendered from {{content}}`	Lora serif 15px italic. Border-left 3px var(--orange). Padding 10px 16px. Background #faf8f5.
Ad Unit 1	`After 3rd-4th paragraph`	Selector: .ad-unit-mid. Background #f8f7f4. Border 0.5px solid var(--border). Border-radius 3px. Padding 12px. Text-align center. Label: 'Advertisement' (8px muted). 300×250 slot. Deferred load: async/defer script. Must not cause CLS.
Ad Unit 2	`After article body, before market widget`	Selector: .ad-unit-post. 728×90 leaderboard desktop. 320×50 mobile banner. Same defer rules as Ad Unit 1.
Market widget	`{{> market-widget-article}}`	Rendered AFTER ad unit 2 and BEFORE related stories.
Related stories	`{{> related-stories}}`	Rendered after market widget. 3-col grid on desktop.

Zone 3b — Article Sidebar (.article-sidebar)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Background	`#ffffff !important`	Must always be white. Never inherits sector colour.
Padding	`24px 16px`	
Position	`sticky; top: 52px;`	Sticks just below the sticky main nav row.
Mobile	`display: none`	Hidden on mobile. Replaced by Key Facts pill strip.

Sidebar contains 4 panels rendered top to bottom:

- Panel 1 — Key Facts (partials/key-facts.hbs)
- Panel 2 — Share Strip
- Panel 3 — Right sidebar ad unit (300×250, desktop only)
- Panel 4 — Newsletter signup mini form (Lora 14px title + DM Sans 10px sub + email input + Subscribe button)

Key Facts Panel (partials/key-facts.hbs)

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Header label	`"Key Facts"`	DM Sans 8px bold orange. Uppercase 0.14em. Border-bottom 2px var(--orange).
Item count	`3-5 facts per article`	Stored as Ghost post metadata. Populated by writing agent at publish time.
Number	`DM Sans 22px bold. Color var(--navy).`	Large stat. Examples: '30%', '90s', '4M', '3'.
Label	`DM Sans 10px. Color var(--text-mid). Line-height 1.4.`	Short description. Example: 'Reduction in material waste'.
Sub-label	`DM Sans 8px. Color var(--text-muted). Margin-top 2px.`	Context note. Example: 'across 12 pilot projects'.
Item separator	`Border-bottom 0.5px var(--border-light). Padding-bottom 14px. Margin-bottom 14px.`	
Share strip	`Below last Key Fact. Top border 0.5px var(--border).`	3 buttons: 'X Post with stat' + 'Share on LinkedIn' + 'Copy link'. Each 9px DM Sans. White bg. 0.5px border.
Mobile replacement	`Horizontal scroll strip above article body. Each fact = pill card (stat number + label). No sidebar.`	

08 DATA WIDGETS

Market Widget (partials/market-widget-article.hbs)

Full implementation in assets/js/market-widget-article.js and assets/css/market-widget.css. Summary of visual spec:

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Container	`.article-market-widget`	Background #f8f7f4. Border 0.5px var(--border). Border-radius 6px. Overflow hidden. Margin: 24px 0.
Header bg	`var(--navy)`	Title: 'ACEM & AI Markets' — DM Sans 13px bold white. 'AI' in orange.
Live indicator	`Green dot (6px, #4ade80, pulsing animation) + 'Live' text`	Dot turns red #f87171 when market is closed.
Ticker strip	`Background #111d2e. DM Sans 9px. Scrolls horizontally via CSS animation.`	Ticker strip is ALWAYS visible. The stock cards grid is tab-filtered.
Tabs	`All Sectors · Construction · Engineering · Manufacturing · AI Infra`	DM Sans 9px bold uppercase. Active: orange bottom border.
Stock cards	`4 per tab (matching sector from article primary_tag)`	Card: sym (12px bold navy) + name (8px muted) + price (14px bold) + % change (9px, green/red) + 52w bar (3px) + AI badge.
Detail panel	`Opens on card click. Shows: sym, name, price, change, market cap, 52w low, 52w high, volume, 'Why this stock' text.`	
Data source	`Yahoo Finance v8 API via allorigins.win CORS proxy. 15min cache in sessionStorage.`	
Disclaimer	`"Data via Yahoo Finance · 15min delayed · Not financial advice"`	8px muted. Always visible. Never remove.
Mobile	`Ticker strip only visible. 'Tap to expand' note. Full grid opens on tap.`	

AI Adoption Tracker — Supabase Schema

Phase 3 feature. Database table for the /tracker page. Run this SQL in Supabase.

```
CREATE TABLE adoption_signals (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT gen_random_uuid(),
```

```
  signal_type text NOT NULL,  --
'job_posting'|'funding'|'patent'|'launch'|'survey'
  sector      text,           --
'construction'|'engineering'|'manufacturing'|'architecture'|'ai'
  company     text,
  value       numeric,        -- dollar amount for funding, count for jobs/patents
  title       text,
  source_url  text,
  signal_date timestamptz NOT NULL,
  week_number integer,
  raw_data    jsonb,
  created_at  timestamptz DEFAULT now()
);
```

09 AI READABILITY LAYER

WHY THIS MATTERS

No ACEM news platform has implemented a full AI readability stack. This layer makes IndustrialBriefs content appear in ChatGPT answers, Perplexity citations, Google AI Overviews, and Bing Copilot. It is the primary SEO competitive moat for 2026.

JSON-LD Schema (partials/json-ld.hbs)

Inject via {{ghost_head}} in default.hbs. Render on every post template. Type: NewsArticle.

```
{{#is 'post'}}
<script type='application/ld+json'>
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "NewsArticle",
  "headline": "{{title}}",
  "datePublished": "{{date format='YYYY-MM-DDTHH:mm:ssZ'}}",
  "dateModified": "{{updated_at format='YYYY-MM-DDTHH:mm:ssZ'}}",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "IndustrialBriefs Newsroom",
    "url": "{{@site.url}}"
  },
  "publisher": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "IndustrialBriefs",
    "logo": { "@type": "ImageObject", "url":
"{{@site.url}}/content/images/logo.png" }
  },
  "articleSection": "{{primary_tag.name}}",
  "keywords": "{{tags}}",
  "description": "{{excerpt words='30'}}",
  "image": "{{img_url feature_image size='m'}}",
  "url": "{{url absolute='true'}}"
}
</script>
{{/is}}
```

Semantic HTML Rules

Rule	Implementation
One h1 per page	Article headline ONLY. Masthead uses <p class='masthead'> not <h1>. Sidebar titles use or <p>. NEVER put h1 in navigation.hbs.
h2 subheadings	Ghost renders {{content}} — ensure theme CSS applies h2 styles (DM Sans bold 15px) to all h2 tags inside .gh-content.
<article> wrapper	Wrap .article-column content in <article itemscope itemtype="https://schema.org/NewsArticle">.
<time> timestamps	<time datetime="{{date format='YYYY-MM-DDTHH:mm:ssZ'}}">{{date format='MMM D, YYYY'}}</time>

<nav> aria-label	<nav aria-label="Primary navigation"> for Row 3. <nav aria-label="Section navigation"> for Row 4.
Alt text on images	{{feature_image_alt}} — writing agent must set this at publish. Falls back to {{title}}.

/llms.txt — Create this file at Ghost theme root

This file describes IndustrialBriefs to AI crawlers. Served at industrialbriefs.com/llms.txt. Create as a Ghost static page or serve via routes.yaml.

```
# IndustrialBriefs

IndustrialBriefs is a daily AI-powered news platform covering
Architecture, Construction, Engineering, and Manufacturing (ACEM).
We publish original news, analysis, and data for professionals
in the built environment and industrial sectors.

## Sections
- Construction: project news, contractors, materials, technology
- Architecture: design practice, urban planning, heritage
- Engineering: civil, structural, mechanical, systems
- Manufacturing: industrial automation, robotics, supply chain
- AI Tools: AI software and platforms adopted in ACEM sectors

## Content Types
- News Brief: 300-500 word factual reports on breaking developments
- News Story: 600-900 word reported stories with context
- Analysis: 800-1200 word sector analysis with data
- Data Report: tracked metrics with charts (AI Adoption Index, Funding Tracker)
- Weekly Brief: curated newsletter digest of top 7 stories
- Industry Insights: clearly-labelled sponsored thought leadership

## Publishing Schedule
Daily, Monday to Friday. Newsletter delivered 6:00am ET.

## Machine-Readable Endpoints
- Articles API: /api/articles (Ghost Content API passthrough)
- Sitemap: /sitemap.xml
- RSS Feed: /rss
```

10 MOBILE RESPONSIVE SPECIFICATION

Three breakpoints. Implement using mobile-first CSS with min-width media queries OR desktop-first with max-width. Each component's mobile behaviour is specified below.

Breakpoint	Range & Behaviour
Desktop	> 1024px — Full layout. All 5 header rows. 3-col article grid. Sidebar beside article. Key Facts sticky.
Tablet	768px – 1024px — Utility row visible. Rail cards shrink to 3. Main nav sticky. 2-col article grid. Sidebar visible.
Mobile	< 768px — See detailed spec below. Single column everything.

Mobile Header

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Row 1 — Utility	`display: none below 768px`	
Row 2 — Rail	`overflow-x: auto; -webkit-overflow-scrolling: touch;`	Horizontal swipe. Scrollbar hidden.
Row 3 — Main	`Show masthead + .m-subscribe button + .m-hamburger only.`	Nav links hidden. Height reduces to 44px.
Row 4 — Tabs	`overflow-x: auto. Horizontal scroll. Scrollbar hidden.`	
Row 5 — Trending	`display: none below 480px`	

Mobile Homepage

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Hero	`Single column. grid-template-columns: 1fr. Top Stories panel below hero text.`	
Article cards	`display: flex; flex-direction: row; Each card: image left 90×90px, text right.`	No grid. Stack vertically with 1px border between cards.
Card image	`width: 90px; height: 90px; flex-shrink: 0; object-fit: cover;`	
Card body	`padding: 10px 12px;`	
Card headline	`Lora serif 13px bold.`	Slightly smaller than desktop 15px.
Load More	`Same as desktop. Full width button on mobile.`	
Newsletter band	`Single column. Centred.`	

Footer	`grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr. Brand col spans both.`	

Mobile Article Page

Property	Value	Notes / Rule
Layout	`Single column. No sidebar.`	grid-template-columns: 1fr on mobile.
Key Facts sidebar	`display: none on mobile`	Replaced by pill strip below.
Key Facts pill strip	`Horizontal scroll strip. Position: between article header and article body.`	Each fact = white card with big stat number + short label. Overflow-x auto. Scrollbar hidden.
Pill card	`Background #fff. Border 0.5px var(--border). Border-radius 6px. Padding 8px 12px.`	Stat: DM Sans 18px bold navy. Label: DM Sans 8px muted. Flex-shrink: 0.
Article body	`padding: 16px 14px`	Smaller padding than desktop 28px 24px.
Article h1	`font-size: 20px (down from 28px)`	
Article body p	`font-size: 15px (down from 16px)`	
Ad Unit 1	`300×250 on mobile same as desktop`	
Ad Unit 2	`320×50 mobile banner (NOT the 728×90 leaderboard)`	Leaderboard does not fit mobile. Use mobile banner slot.
Market widget	`Ticker strip only. 'Tap to expand' note. Cards open on tap.`	
Share strip	`Horizontal 3 buttons below article body. Full width.`	
Related stories	`Single column card list. Image left thumb 56×44px + title + meta.`	
Min tap target	`44px height on all interactive elements`	WCAG 2.1 AA requirement.
No autoplay	`No audio/video autoplay on any element`	
No interstitial	`No full-screen ads on page load`	

11 DESIGN CONSTRAINTS — WHAT NEVER TO DO

These are absolute rules. They cannot be overridden by any other instruction, design preference, or aesthetic consideration.

Constraint	Reason
NEVER apply sector accent colour to any background	Causes the green/orange/purple page bug visible in the live site. Sector colours on text + left-border only.
NEVER render a reading progress bar	Explicitly removed from all templates. Not on article page, not in header, not anywhere.
NEVER render an 'AI Written' or 'AI Generated' badge	No major publisher labels AI authorship. Erodes trust. Removed permanently.
NEVER fire an interstitial ad on page load	Google CLS penalty. Directly demotes search rankings. Use deferred in-article units only.
NEVER place any ad before article content loads	Content must reach first contentful paint before any ad script executes.
NEVER mix sponsor content into editorial feed without Sponsored badge	FTC compliance. Google helpful content penalty. Amber badge always visible.
NEVER use infinite scroll	Numbered pagination only. Infinite scroll breaks AI crawlers and article discoverability.
NEVER place a sidebar beside the article reading column on mobile	Sidebars collapse badly. Article layout is single column on mobile. Sidebar is hidden.
NEVER use h1 on the masthead or any navigation element	One h1 per page = the article headline. Ghost themes commonly break this.
NEVER autoplay audio or video	ACEM audience reads during work hours in open offices.
NEVER place ads in mobile sidebar	No sidebar on mobile. All mobile ads are in-article only (300×250 mid + 320×50 post-body).
NEVER implement bottom tab bar in Phase 2	Deferred to Phase 3. Hamburger drawer is sufficient.

12 IMPLEMENTATION EXECUTION ORDER

Execute in this exact order. Do not jump ahead. Each step depends on the previous.

1. Create Ghost theme folder structure (Section 02). Create all files as empty shells. Validate package.json.
2. Paste CSS variables into screen.css (Section 03). Verify :root block compiles. Add dark mode block.
3. Add Google Fonts link tag to default.hbs <head> (Section 04). Verify Lora and DM Sans load.
4. Build default.hbs master layout: html shell + head meta tags + {{ghost_head}} + {{> navigation}} + {{{body}}} + {{> footer}} + {{ghost_foot}} + asset script tags.
5. Build partials/navigation.hbs with all 5 rows (Section 05). Add sticky position to Row 3. Test all 5 rows render.
6. Apply the CRITICAL BUG FIX CSS rules (Section 05, Tag Component). Verify article page background is white. Verify green/colour bleed is resolved.
7. Build the tag component CSS (Section 05, Tag Component). Test all 5 sector tag classes. Verify no background colour on any tag.
8. Build partials/footer.hbs (Section 06, Zone 7).
9. Build index.hbs homepage with all 7 zones (Section 06). Test hero, article grid, load more, newsletter band.
10. Build partials/loop.hbs article card component. Test 3-col grid. Verify no AI badge renders.
11. Build post.hbs article page with full layout grid (Section 07). Test white background. Test single h1.
12. Build partials/key-facts.hbs (Section 07). Test sticky behaviour. Test mobile pill strip.
13. Build partials/json-ld.hbs (Section 09). Inject via ghost_head. Validate with Google Rich Results Test.
14. Add semantic HTML: <article> wrapper, <time> tags, <nav> aria-labels (Section 09).
15. Create /llms.txt file content (Section 09). Serve at site root.
16. Copy assets/js/market-widget-article.js and assets/css/market-widget.css into theme (Section 08). Add partials/market-widget-article.hbs. Test ticker renders.
17. Build mobile responsive CSS for all components (Section 10). Test at 375px width (iPhone SE) and 768px (tablet).
18. Build assets/js/main.js: drawer open/close, dark mode toggle, section tab active states, smooth scroll to #subscribe.
19. Run gscan against Ghost 6.x. Resolve all errors before deployment.
20. Deploy to Ghost. Verify: no green background, no progress bar, no AI badge, white article page, tags render correctly.

DOCUMENT COMPLETE

This document contains every decision needed to build the IndustrialBriefs Ghost theme. No clarifying questions are needed. Execute the 20-step implementation order in Section 12 from top to bottom.

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